

PROPOSAL WRITING

Presented by Group

TODAY'S AGENDA

01

What is Proposal Writing?

Definition & purpose

02

Types of Proposals

Research, grant, business & more

03

Business Proposals – Deep Dive

Internal vs external, types

04

How to Write a Business Proposal

Step-by-step process

05

Key Elements & Structure

What every section must include

06

Dos and Don'ts

Common mistakes & best practices

07

Influencing Decision-Makers

Role of each section

08

Recap

Summary

WHAT IS PROPOSAL WRITING?

A proposal is a formal written document that presents an idea, solution, or plan to persuade a reader ,decision-maker, stakeholder, or client to approve, fund, or act upon it.



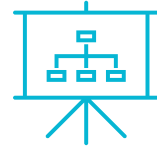
Identify a Problem

Clearly states an existing challenge or need that demands attention



Propose a Solution

Offers a concrete, well reasoned answer to address the problem



Persuade & Justify

Uses evidence, cost benefit analysis and logic to earn approval

TYPES OF PROPOSALS

Proposals exist across many fields. Here are the main categories:

Business Proposal

Propose solution to meet business need.

Research Proposal

Seek approval and funding for research

Grant Proposal

Request financial from funders.

Project Proposal

Outline scope, timeline and resources for a new project.

Sales Proposal

Persuade a customer to sign a contract or close a deal.

Budget Proposal

Request approval for a specific budget.

BUSINESS PROPOSALS: INTERNAL vs EXTERNAL

INTERNAL PROPOSAL

- ▶ Written WITHIN the organisation
- ▶ Author: Employee / department head
- ▶ Reader: Management / executives
- ▶ Goal: Ask for approval
- ▶ Tone: Professional but familiar
- ▶ Examples: Asking for more new equipment's

EXTERNAL PROPOSAL

- ▶ Sent OUTSIDE the organisation
- ▶ Author: Sales
- ▶ Reader: Potential client / partner
- ▶ Goal: Win a contract
- ▶ Tone: Formal and sales-oriented
- ▶ Examples: Website development for client

TYPES OF INTERNAL BUSINESS PROPOSALS

Technology / IT Upgrade

- Request for new software or system.

Staffing & Hiring

- Request for new employee or role.

Budget Request

- Asking for additional funds

New Project / Initiative

- Proposal for new project or service.

Training & Development

- Request for employee training.

THE PROPOSAL WRITING PROCESS

1

Identify the Problem

Research and clearly define the problem. Understand the impact.

2

Know Your Audience

Who approves this? What concerns them? Budget? Risk? Efficiency?

3

Develop Your Solution

Brainstorm options. Choose the best one. Plan the implementation.

4

Outline the Proposal

Map out sections. Ensure logical flow from problem to solution to action.

5

Write the First Draft

Write clearly and concisely. Use simple language. Avoid jargon.

6

Add Data & Evidence

Include research, statistics, case studies, cost estimates.

7

Review & Edit

Proofread for grammar. Check facts. Get feedback from a colleague.

8

Submit & Follow Up

Submit formally. Be ready to answer questions and defend your proposal.

KEY ELEMENTS OF A BUSINESS PROPOSAL

1 Title Page

Proposal name, author, department, date, recipient

2 Executive Summary

A snapshot of the whole proposal the most read section

3 Problem Statement

What is the issue? Why does it matter? What happens if nothing is done?

4 Proposed Solution

Describe your solution clearly what, how, who, when

5 Project Plan / Timeline

Milestones, responsibilities, Gantt chart or timeline

6 Budget & Resources

Detailed cost breakdown staff, tools, time, overhead

7 Benefits & ROI

What does the organisation gain? Quantify savings, efficiency gains, risk reduction

8 Conclusion

Summarise the key points. Tell the reader exactly what you want them to do next

9 Appendices

Supporting data, references, technical specs, research sources

DOS AND DON'TS IN PROPOSAL WRITING

DO

Research the problem thoroughly before writing

Use clear, plain language avoid jargon

Tailor the proposal to your specific audience

Support every claim with data or evidence

Keep it concise quality over quantity

Use headings and visuals for easy scanning

Write the executive summary last

Proofread multiple times before submitting

DON'T

Use vague language like 'we will try' or 'maybe'

Exaggerate benefits or underestimate costs

Write for yourself always write for the reader

Submit without proofreading for errors

Include irrelevant information to bulk up the document

Use a template without customising it

Forget to include a clear call to action

Send without getting a peer review first

ACTIVITY

Write a Mini Internal Proposal Outline

- 1 Choose ONE scenario from the list below:
- 2 Write a bullet-point outline covering: Problem, Solution, Plan, Budget (rough), and Call to Action
- 3 One group member presents the outline to the class (2 min per group)

Scenarios: A) New laptop upgrade for team B) Hire one more staff member C) Launch internal monthly newsletter D) Move to 4-day work week pilot

KEY TAKEAWAYS

A proposal is a persuasive document always write for your reader, not for yourself

Internal proposals are the most common type in professional life master this first

Start with a clear, specific problem vague problems produce vague proposals

Every claim needs evidence data, statistics, and cost-benefit analysis are essential

Follow the structure: Title → Executive Summary → Problem → Solution → Plan → Budget → CTA

The Executive Summary, Budget and Conclusion are the three most-read sections perfect them

Always proofread, get feedback, and tailor your proposal before submission

THANK YOU

Questions & Discussion

*"A well-written proposal is not just a document
it is a bridge between your idea and its approval."*

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